Gritty Rock Vocal

Sounds like: 90s alt-rock lead vocal (Foo Fighters / grunge era)

ACCURACY B

Close enough to fool most ears.

NOT YET TESTED - settings are a starting point; trust your ears

WHAT YOU NEED (in this order)

`Channel strip (HPF + EQ + comp) -> parallel Scream 4 (via Spider Audio) -> RV7000 MkII plate (send)`

Starting material: dynamic mic (SM7B/SM58-ish), untreated or semi-treated room

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DO THIS, STEP BY STEP

1. Channel strip: engage HPF at 80 Hz. EQ: cut 2–3 dB around 300 Hz (LMF), boost 2 dB at 3 kHz (HMF) for bite.

2. Channel strip compressor: ratio around 4:1, fast attack OFF, release medium. Aim for 4–6 dB gain reduction on loud phrases.

3. Split the vocal with a Spider Audio: path A dry, path B into Scream 4.

4. Scream 4: Damage type Tube, Damage ~35, P1 ~60, P2 ~50. Cut section: lows -20. Master level down so it sits UNDER the dry path.

5. Blend the Scream path in at roughly -10 dB relative to dry — you should feel it, not hear it as distortion.

6. Send to RV7000 MkII: algorithm Plate, decay 1.1 s, predelay 30 ms, HF damp on. Send level low — rock vocals stay dry-ish.

Why this works

The dry path keeps consonants intact; the parallel Scream adds harmonics that read as "power" at mix level.

Why this order

Compress BEFORE the parallel split so both paths get a consistent level — otherwise the grit pumps.

Reason trick

Build the whole thing in a Combinator 2 and map one macro knob to the Scream path's level. That knob is now a "grit" control per song section.

The skill you just learned

Parallel saturation: distort a copy, tuck it under the clean signal.

Worth buying?
None needed at B. If you chase A: a tape/console emulation (e.g., Softube Tape, ~$99) rounds the top end.